

Path to \$1,000,000

What investment is, why you need it,
and how to get started – even if you've never
heard the word "portfolio"

Before you start

This book was written by the SWC team – a community of people who spent about 12 years financing a major infrastructure project. We're not financiers with Wall Street degrees. We are people who made expensive mistakes, spent a long time figuring things out, and ultimately realized something important.

This is not an investment textbook. This is an honest conversation, without promises of golden mountains and without clever words for the sake of clever words.

Our only goal is that when you close the last page, you should have one specific next step. Not a list of a hundred things to do, not a feeling of information overload. One step.

It is read in 25-30 minutes. With a cup of coffee.

An investor is not the one who has more money at the start. This is someone who has learned to handle the money they have wisely.

CHAPTER 1

The Trap of Good Life

Why more money doesn't mean more freedom

You're making good money. Or normal. Or you plan to earn more, and then, finally, everything will fall into place.

But let's be honest.

When you got your first promotion, did you feel financial freedom? Most likely not. Because along with the salary, everything else has increased: a better apartment, a newer car, longer vacations, a newer phone. Expenses always catch up with income. It's not a vulnerable point. It's mechanics.

Living standards is rising along with income. But the level of freedom is not. Because freedom is not measured by how much you earn. But how much it works without you.

There are three types of people. They do not differ in income level. They differ in what happens to your money after it comes to your account.

Type I. There is money, but no capital

Successful person. Career is on the rise. Every year is a little better than the previous one. But by the end of the month the money runs out – not because there is not enough of it, but because the lifestyle absorbs everything that comes.

If tomorrow's income falls by half, there will be a crisis. Not because a person does not work well. Just because there is nothing that would work instead of it.

The money is earned. But doesn't accumulate.

Second type. Saves but doesn't invest

This person is disciplined. Puts aside some money every month. A stash is growing on the account or at home. This is already better, right?

Almost.

Because money that's just lying around doesn't stand still. It slowly lose its value. This is not a metaphor. It's math. And that's what the next chapter is about.

Third type. Invests

This person has assets. Money works while they goes about their life. Their income does not depend entirely on whether they went to work today or not.

An important point: most people in this category didn't start with a large sum. They started by understanding how the system worked.

The difference between the second and third types is not in the amount. In one decision: stop saving money and start investing it in assets.

Which of the three categories are you in now?

Do not be so quick with your answer. Read it once again. Most people think they are the second type, when in fact they are the first.

In the next chapter, we'll look at something that no one talks about directly: why money that's just sitting is not a saving, but a loss.

CHAPTER 2

Silent Robbery

How your money disappears even when it stays with you

Imagine you put \$1,000 in a drawer. Close it. Ten years later you open it and the money is there. The same bills, the same amount.

But you will be able to buy less with them.

This is inflation. Not an economic term from a textbook. It's a specific mechanism that quietly takes away part of your wealth every year - even when you don't spend anything.

2015

\$1,000

= several iPhones

2025

\$1,000

= one iPhone

Money is the same. Value is half.

This does not happen overnight. Inflation works quietly, year after year, behind the scenes. That's why it's so dangerous: you don't feel it in the moment. You feel it ten years later, when you look back and realize: you saved and saved, but you didn't become richer.

And here is an important shift in understanding.

Most people think that investing is a decision to pay. Invest money, take a risk, do something. But the truth is the opposite: you are already paying. Every month. Keeping silent. Inflation takes its fee automatically, regardless of whether you do anything with your money or not.

Inaction is not free. It's just a bill that comes later and looks different.

The choice is not really between "to invest or not to invest." The choice is to consciously pay for the tools that work for you, or pay in silence, giving up to inflation what could have grown.

Keeping money means losing it slowly. Inaction costs money. It's just that no one sends this bill.

Liabilities versus Assets

The money that sits is a liability. It exists, but produce nothing. Over time, it loses purchasing power, that is, what it can be exchanged for.

Money invested in an asset works. An asset can generate regular income (rent, dividends) or increase in value. Or both.

The difference between a liability and an asset is the difference between money sitting idle and money working.

Why an apartment isn't always an asset

Many people think: the apartment I bought is an asset. In a certain sense, yes. But let's calculate honestly.

The apartment was purchased for \$150,000. It is rented for \$600 per month - \$7,200 per year. This is 4.8% per annum. Sounds quite good. But take into account: taxes, repairs, downtime between tenants, your time for management.

The real yield is 2-3% per annum. Sometimes even less than inflation.

This does not mean that the property is bad. This means counting, not taking for granted.

The main question to ask about every dollar is:
"Is this money working - or is it just sitting?"

In the next chapter, we will figure out how exactly money can work and what tools exist for different purposes and risk levels.



CHAPTER 3

How money Becomes an Asset

Three levels – three tasks

There is no one "right" tool for everyone. There are tools with different tasks. Understanding this means doing half the job.

There are three levels. Everyone answers their own question.

Level one: not to lose

- Deposits, government bonds, gold.

Their job is not to make you a fortune. Their job is to preserve what you have. This is a parking lot for money that you might need. Not a garage where the car increases in value. A parking lot.

Gold does not reproduce. One gram after twenty years is still the same gram. But it will retain purchasing power. This is its function.

These tools will not answer the question "how to get rich." They will answer the question "how not to start over again."

The protective part of the portfolio is not an insurance against greed. This is an insurance against life.

Level 2: to grow

- Shares of mature companies, real estate, operating business.

These tools yield 10-20% per annum with a reasonable approach, plus operating income: dividends or rental payments. This is real money that comes in regularly as long as you own the asset.

Example. You bought a share of a large American company for \$1,000. Every year it pays out \$80 in dividends, which is 8% per annum. In dollars. In a tool that sells on any business day in a few seconds.

Compare with an apartment for rent. Not in favor of the apartment.

Yes, such assets can temporarily fall in value during crises. But if the horizon is long and the company is of high quality, these are temporary fluctuations, not a disaster.

Level three: growth potential

- This is where what is called venture capital investment comes in.

"Venture" in English means adventure. And this is the exact word. Not excitement. Not casino. But conscious adventure – with open eyes and accepted risk.

This is an investment in projects with multiple growth potential. Not 10% per annum. But $\times 10$, $\times 100$. Sometimes more.

Bitcoin was worth less than a dollar in 2012. Amazon shares were worth \$18 in 1997. Now – thousands. At the time of the decision, no one knew for sure. But someone analyzed, weighed up – and made an informed choice.

Venture is not about luck. It is about a conscious risk. The difference is that with luck you hope. With a conscious risk, you choose, knowing what you're doing.

The main thing to understand is that none of these levels works on their own as a full-fledged strategy. They work together. And this is what the next chapter is about.

CHAPTER 4

Portfolio Logic

Why one bet isn't a strategy

Imagine the best venture capital fund in the world. Smart people, experienced analysts, years of practice. They take \$10,000,000 and invest it in 100 projects.

Here's what happens next:

PROJECTS	RESULT
90 of 100	Had failed
8 of 100	Moderate growth - $\times 2$, $\times 5$
2 of 100	Explosive growth - $\times 100$, $\times 1000$

These two projects out of a hundred cover all losses and generate profit for the fund.

Now imagine another scenario: all \$10,000,000 goes into one project. One bad choice and it's all gone.

That is why professional investors never put all eggs in one basket. Not because they are afraid. Because they understand maths.

One project is a bet. A portfolio of different instruments - is a strategy. The difference is not in the risk. In the system.

This works at any scale.

You don't need \$10,000,000 to build a portfolio. The right proportion is needed.

Example. You earn \$1,500 per month and are willing to invest 10% – \$150.

Here's what it might look like:

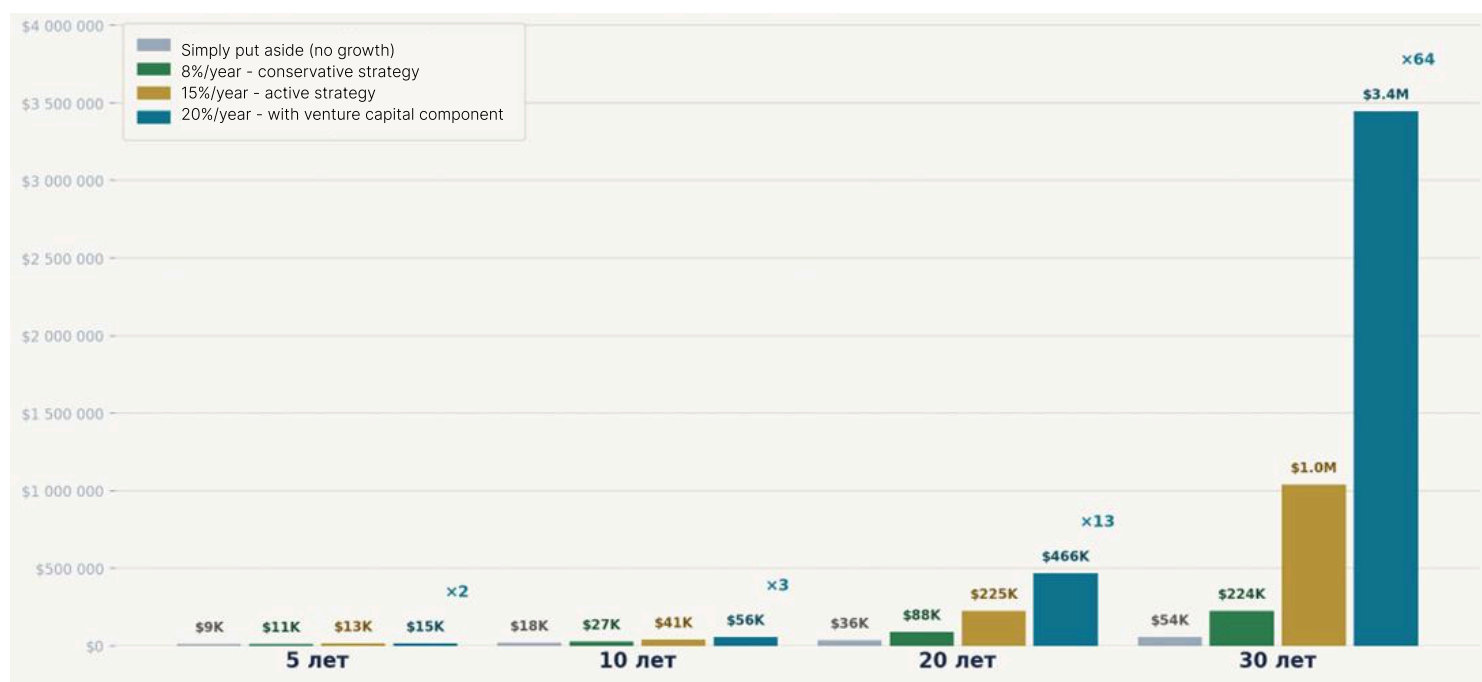
- **70–80%** \$105–120 – protective and medium-risk instruments (dividend shares, bonds)
- **20–30%** \$30–45 – projects with high growth potential

If the venture part doesn't produce results, life won't collapse. If it does, it can change it drastically.

If the amount seems small, look at it differently. One of the most powerful principles in finance works here: compound interest. Einstein called it the eighth wonder of the world. The bottom line is simple: income is accrued not only on the invested amount, but also on the already accumulated income. The longer it takes, the stronger the effect. Here's what happens to \$150 per month in different horizons:

Power of Compound Interest: \$150 per Month

What happens to regular investments over different time horizons and with different returns



* Calculation using the compound interest formula for monthly installments of \$150. The figures are rounded for clarity.

Term	Invested	With 8%/year	With 15%/year	With 20%/year
5 years	\$9,000	\$11,000	\$13,300	\$15,300
10 years	\$18,000	\$27,400	\$41,300	\$56,400
20 years	\$36,000	\$88,400	\$224,600	\$466,400
30 years	\$54,000	\$223,600	\$1,038,500	\$3,446,700

Over 30 years, \$54,000 has been invested. With conservative 8% per annum, the account has \$223,600. With active strategy of 15% – more than \$1,000,000. And with 20% per annum, which is realistic with a proper combination of dividend stocks and a venture component, it is \$3,446,700.

This is the compound effect: it's not the size of your investment that makes the difference, but time, consistency, and the tool that works for you.

Four reasons why people don't start. And the answer to each of them.

Almost everyone who has never invested gives the same reasons. Let's discuss them honestly.

1. "I am short on funds" – short on funds. There is the part of those you have. At least 5-10%. Getting started is more important than starting with a large amount.
2. "I don't understand anything about investing" – you don't need to understand everything. You need to have access to professional analytics that has already done this work for you.

3. "I'm afraid to lose" – this is normal. This is why a portfolio is built with a balance: the defensive part insures the risky part. Some of the money always works in a low-risk mode.
4. "I don't have time to figure it out" – this is the most honest reason. And that's why we exist.

"No time to figure it out" is not a weakness. This is the reality of a busy person. Investments should not require you to spend hours studying charts and financial statements. Our task is to remove this barrier completely. You get ready-made, proven solutions: what to consider, why, and in what ratio. Not a finance course. A work tool that works even if you've been doing other things all day.

The last chapter is about what we have built at SWC for those who want to start but don't know where to start.

CHAPTER 5

SWC and Your First Step

History of community and tool we created

About twelve years ago, several thousand people around the world united around one project – a major infrastructure technology. They believed in it. Financed it. Were waiting.

At some point, we stopped and asked ourselves an honest question: who are we as a community? What unites us?

The answer turned out to be unexpected.

We are not a group of people who have invested money in one project. We are people who know how to make financial decisions in the face of uncertainty. Who think for the long term. Who understand the difference between an asset and the illusion of an asset.

In other words, we are a community of investors.

An investor is not someone who has once invested money somewhere. An investor is someone who knows how to manage their cash flow competently and build a balanced portfolio.

What we have created

We did not go towards new promises and beautiful presentations. We went towards a specific tool with a clear value.

This is how SWC PASS emerged.

SWC PASS is a subscription to tools and knowledge **that make an investor an investor.**

Not a course. Not a social club. A working tool.

What is included in the subscription

Today, the SWC PASS includes two key products.

- **Road to \$1M Road to \$1M** is monthly analytics with specific recommendations: which dividend shares to consider for the portfolio, how to assess them, how to balance risks. This product is already available. Similar analytics on the market cost more than the entire SWC PASS subscription.
- **SWC Field SWC Field** is a showcase of venture capital projects where community members gain access to opportunities that are usually open only to large capital. The launch is coming soon, all necessary licenses have already been obtained.

Over time, new features will be added to the subscription: events, access to financial advisors, advanced analytics. But it's already a working tool with real value.

A person does not have to understand all the intricacies of the stock market. They need to have access to professional expertise - and make an informed choice.

Important clarification

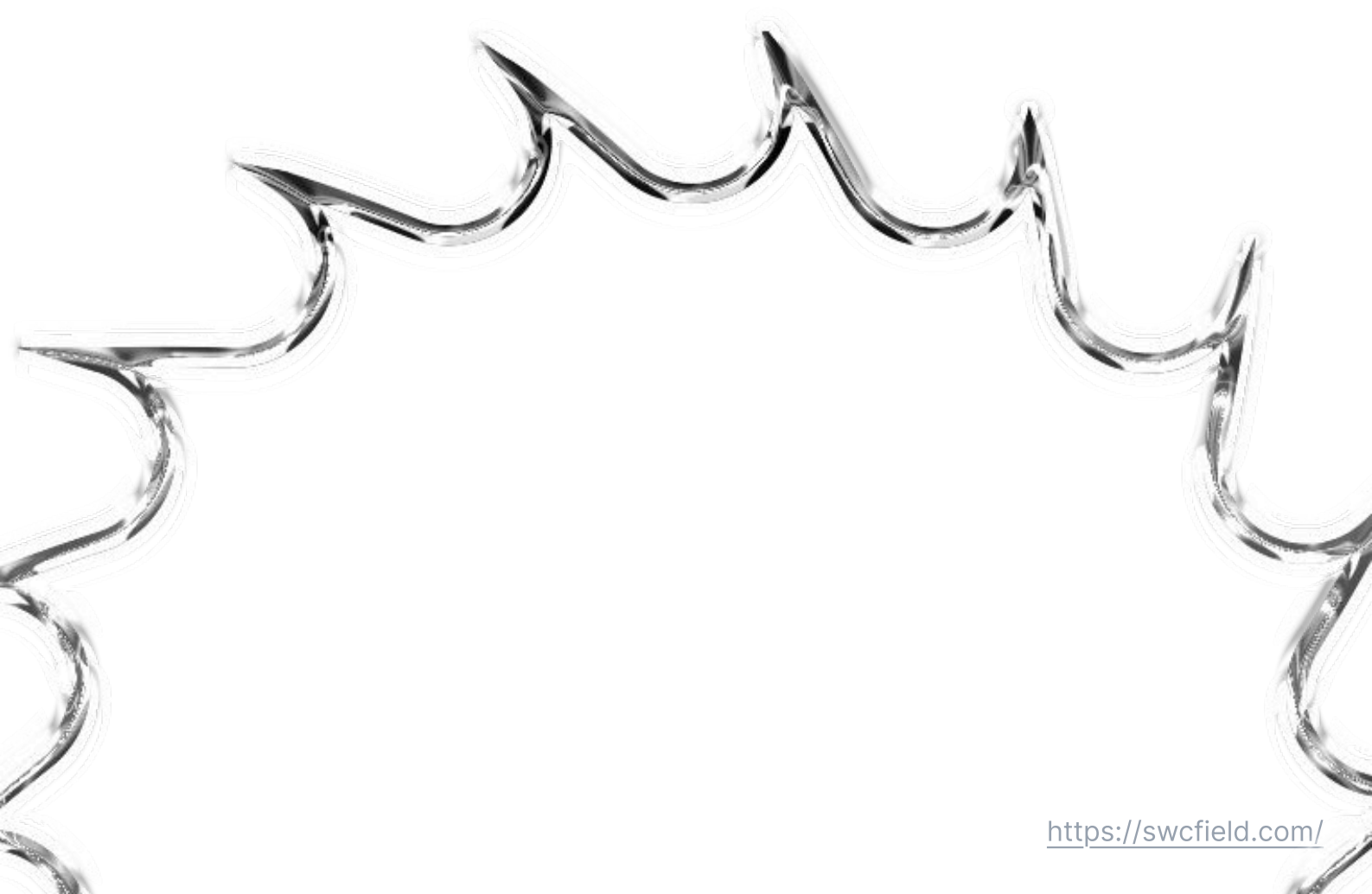
SWC PASS is an information service. We provide analytics and knowledge. We are not responsible for market fluctuations and force majeure circumstances. The final decision is always yours.

We do not promise guaranteed returns. No one should promise this.

What we promise: you'll get a tool that helps you make more informed decisions. And this is a huge step compared to when the money is just sitting.

Value

An annual subscription costs \$240 – that's \$20 a month, less than one trip to a restaurant. Subscription for 5 years – \$600, that is, \$10 per month: for those who think for the long time and want to freeze the price. And lifetime access for \$2,600 – once, forever, without ever having to renew it.



Instead of a conclusion

You have read this book. This means that the question “why to invest” is no longer so pressing. Now the question is different.

When?

Not "if". Not "when there is more money." Not "when I figure it out better."

The most expensive investment resource is not capital. It's time. Every year when the money is sitting and not working is a year that cannot be returned.

We are not saying: invest everything right now. We say: take the first step. Small, conscious, specific.

Remember: there is no choice between “paying or not paying”. You're already paying - by inflation, lost time, and delayed start. The only question is whether you are paying for inaction or for a tool that works for you.

The next step is conversation.

We hold meetings where we answer questions and show how the SWC PASS works in practice.

Without pressure. Without selling from the stage.

Just a conversation between people who have already figured it out and those who are just starting out.

**For the link to register for the next meeting
please contact the person who gave you this book.
Or write to us directly.**

SWC Team



<https://swcfield.com/>

